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TOURISM DEVELOPMENT REPORT

Creating and Marketing of a Destination-Based Tourism Product:

A Case Study on Botiaghata, Khulna

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Table of Contents

Executive Summary

List of Figures

List of Tables

1. Introduction

- 1.1 Background
- 1.2 Rationale for Selecting Botiaghata
- 1.3 Problem / Opportunity Statement
- 1.4 Aim of the Project
- 1.5 Objectives
- 1.6 Scope of the Project

2. Destination Overview

- 2.1 Botiaghata as a Tourism Destination
- 2.2 Natural and Riverside Attractions
- 2.3 Existing Tourism Potential
- 2.4 Current Development Situation

3. Proposed Tourism Product Concept

4. Tourism Product Life Cycle Analysis

5. SWOT Analysis

6. Market Segmentation and Target Markets

7. Core Tourism Experience and Product Portfolio

8. Tourist Itinerary

9. Infrastructure and Visitor Facility Plan

10. Proposed Destination Spatial Layout

11. Phased Destination Development Plan

12. Sustainability and Community Engagement

13. Destination Marketing Strategy

14. Stakeholder Management

15. Risk and Challenge Management

16. Budget and Financial Plan

17. Monitoring and Evaluation Framework (KPIs)

18. Conclusion

List of Figures

Figure 1. Riverside view of Botiaghata at dusk

Figure 2. Local boats along the Botiaghata riverbank

Figure 3. Proposed spatial layout of Botiaghata tourism development

List of Tables

Table 1. Tourism Product Life Cycle — stages and strategic actions

Table 2. TOWS strategy matrix

Table 3. Target market segmentation

Table 4. Sample one-day tourist itinerary

Table 5. Phased destination development roadmap

Table 6. 7Ps marketing mix for Botiaghata

Table 7. Proposed digital marketing plan

Table 8. Promotional campaign framework

Table 9. Stakeholder engagement matrix

Table 10. Risk and mitigation matrix

Table 11. Indicative development budget

Table 12. Proposed monitoring and evaluation indicators (KPIs)

Executive Summary

Botiaghata is a riverside locality in Khulna District, Bangladesh, currently visited informally by local residents and nearby travellers for its open riverbank, natural scenery, and calm atmosphere. It has no established hotels, organized activities, or guided tourism services, and is not featured in commercial travel packages. This report sets out a structured proposal for developing Botiaghata into a recognized destination-based tourism product, prepared as an academic planning exercise for the course THM251 – Tourism Product, Planning and Marketing Lab.

The proposed tourism opportunity centres on riverside tranquility: a low-cost, high-value leisure experience built around boating, riverside walking, eco-park recreation, floating dining concepts, and exposure to local riverine culture. Using the Tourism Product Life Cycle framework, the destination is assessed as being in the Exploration stage, with a clear pathway toward Involvement and Development through phased, community-anchored investment rather than large-scale commercial development.

The target market is led by local and regional day visitors — families, students, university groups, and weekend travellers from Khulna and neighbouring districts — with couples and nature or photography enthusiasts as a complementary segment, and international or expatriate visitors positioned as a longer-term, future market. The development strategy proposed in this report follows three phases: basic clean-up, safety, and access improvements in Year 1; structured tourism infrastructure such as floating cafés, a tourist information centre, and licensed boat services in Years 2–3; and diversification into homestays, cultural programming, and sustainability systems in Years 4–5.

The infrastructure approach is intentionally incremental, prioritizing sanitation, safe boating, signage, and a small tourist information centre ahead of larger capital works. The marketing strategy applies the 7Ps framework around the recommended destination slogan “Botiaghata – Where the River Whispers Peace,” supported by a digital-first promotional plan (social media, short-form video, QR-based storytelling) and a set of community-facing campaigns already conceived in the original project brief, including the Sunset Stories photo contest and an Eco-Volunteer Programme.

Sustainability and community engagement are treated as prerequisites for growth rather than later additions: waste management, controlled visitor numbers, river protection, and local livelihood creation are built into every development phase. An indicative development budget of Tk. 87,50,000 BDT (approximately USD 80,000) is presented across thirteen cost categories, sourced from the original project estimate and re-organized by development phase; this figure is a planning estimate rather than a verified quotation.

If implemented in a phased and community-inclusive manner, Botiaghata has the potential to become a recognized weekend and day-trip destination for the Khulna region, generating local employment and small-enterprise opportunities while remaining environmentally and socially sustainable. The remainder of this report presents the destination analysis, product concept, infrastructure and development plan, marketing strategy, and monitoring framework that support this proposal.

1. Introduction

1.1 Background

The tourism industry in Bangladesh is gradually diversifying beyond established urban and hill destinations, as domestic travellers increasingly seek quiet, offbeat locations for short leisure trips. Botiaghata, a riverside locality in Khulna District, is well positioned to respond to this shift. Set beside a wide river, open roads, and green surroundings, it offers a combination of natural scenery and calm that suits both leisure and recreational tourism, even though it is not yet widely recognized as a tourist destination.

This report applies a structured tourism-planning approach to Botiaghata, combining destination life-cycle analysis, SWOT evaluation, product design, infrastructure and development planning, and a destination marketing strategy. The intention is to show how a currently informal riverside site can be developed into a marketable, sustainable tourism product without compromising its natural character.

1.2 Rationale for Selecting Botiaghata

Botiaghata was selected as the subject of this project for several reasons grounded in its existing character and location:

- **Natural asset base:** the riverbank, open sky, and green landscape provide the core resource for a leisure and eco-tourism product without requiring the site to be built up from nothing.
- **Accessibility:** the location is reachable from Khulna city, placing it within reach of a substantial regional population of potential day visitors.
- **Low initial development cost:** because the site's appeal is primarily natural, early-stage development can proceed through basic infrastructure rather than large capital works.
- **Alignment with demand trends:** growing domestic interest in peaceful, offbeat destinations matches what Botiaghata already offers.
- **Community benefit potential:** structured tourism development creates a realistic opportunity for local employment and small enterprise around a resource the community already has access to.

1.3 Problem / Opportunity Statement

At present, Botiaghata functions as an informal, self-organized visitor site rather than a planned tourism destination. It has no established hotels, structured activities, guided tours, public sanitation, or organized safety provision, and it does not appear in commercial travel packages or mainstream travel platforms. Visitors are almost entirely local residents and a small number of nearby travellers who use the riverbank and roads on an ad hoc basis. This represents an opportunity: the destination already has the natural resource base that most locations must first create, and the planning gap is one of organization, infrastructure, and promotion rather than fundamental attractiveness.

1.4 Aim of the Project

The aim of this project is to develop a strategic and practical roadmap for transforming Botiaghata from an informally visited riverside site into a structured, marketable, and sustainable destination-based tourism product.

1.5 Objectives

- To assess Botiaghata's current position using the Tourism Product Life Cycle and SWOT frameworks.
- To define a tourism product concept and core visitor experience appropriate to the destination's natural character.
- To identify realistic target markets and a corresponding segmentation strategy.
- To propose a phased infrastructure and destination development plan.
- To design a destination marketing strategy using the 7Ps framework, branding, and a digital promotion plan.
- To outline sustainability safeguards, community engagement measures, and an indicative budget and monitoring framework.

1.6 Scope of the Project

This report is a strategic and conceptual planning exercise prepared for the THM251 Tourism Product, Planning and Marketing Lab. It covers destination assessment, tourism product design, infrastructure and development planning, marketing strategy, sustainability considerations, and an indicative budget. It does not constitute an engineering feasibility study, a certified financial appraisal, or a market research report backed by primary survey data; costs, timelines, and targets presented in the plan are estimates and planning assumptions intended to demonstrate the applicable tourism-planning methodology, not verified figures.

2. Destination Overview

2.1 Botiaghata as a Tourism Destination

Botiaghata is a riverside locality in Khulna District, in southwestern Bangladesh, set along a wide river with an open, undeveloped bank. It is currently known primarily to local residents and a limited number of nearby travellers rather than to the wider domestic tourism market, and it does not appear on established tourism circuits.

2.2 Natural and Riverside Attractions

The destination's core appeal is its natural riverside setting: a slow-moving river, wide open skies, scenic roads, and green surroundings that together create a calm, uncrowded atmosphere. Small fishing and passenger boats are a regular feature of the riverbank, adding visual and cultural interest to the landscape.



Figure 1. Riverside view of Botiaghata at dusk

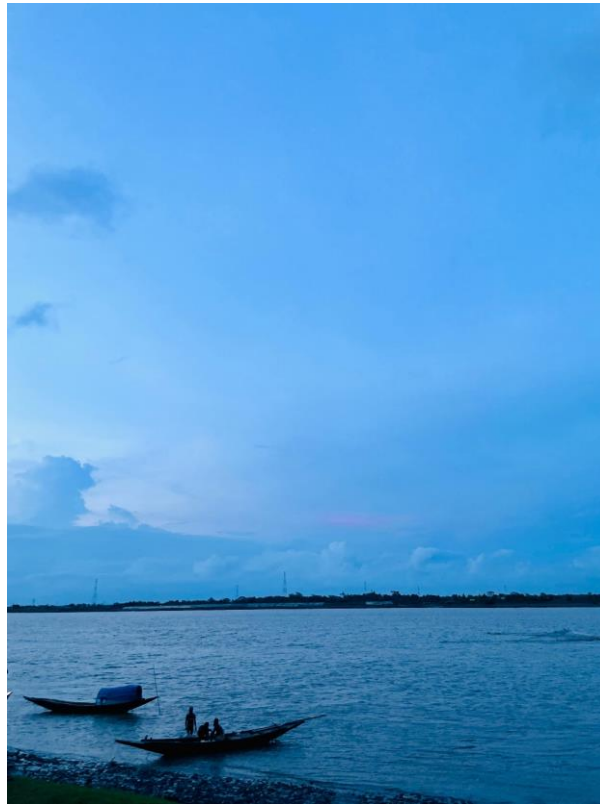


Figure 2. Local boats along the Botiaghata riverbank

2.3 Existing Tourism Potential

Botiaghata's potential rests on qualities that are already present rather than qualities that would need to be created: a genuine riverside setting, proximity to Khulna city, low background noise and congestion, and an authentic, largely untouched character. These qualities support a leisure and light eco-tourism product built around boating, walking, photography, and riverside relaxation.

2.4 Current Development Situation

Tourism activity at Botiaghata today is unplanned and unmanaged. There is no dedicated visitor infrastructure — no public toilets, organized parking, signage, food service, or safety provision — and no formal body currently manages visitor flow or environmental impact at the site. This situation is discussed further in Section 4 using the Tourism Product Life Cycle framework, which places Botiaghata in the Exploration stage of destination development.

3. Proposed Tourism Product Concept

3.1 Destination Concept

The proposed concept positions Botiaghata as a peaceful riverside leisure destination for day and weekend visitors — a place to slow down, enjoy the river, and experience an authentic, low-intensity form of rural Bangladeshi tourism. The concept deliberately avoids large-scale commercial development in favour of a small number of well-designed, nature-compatible visitor experiences.

3.2 Core Value Proposition

Botiaghata offers an accessible, affordable escape from urban life within easy reach of Khulna: natural scenery and riverside calm, without the cost, distance, or crowding associated with more established destinations. This combination of proximity, affordability, and tranquility is the destination's central value proposition.

3.3 Visitor Experience

The intended visitor experience is centred on slow, restorative activity — riverside walking, boating, photography, and shared meals — rather than high-intensity entertainment. Section 7 sets out this experience in full.

3.4 Tourism Product Components

The proposed product can be described using the standard three-layer tourism product model:

- **Core product:** the fundamental benefit sought by the visitor — rest, natural scenery, and psychological distance from city life.
- **Actual product:** the tangible experience delivered — the riverbank walk, boat ride, eco-park, and food and refreshment offerings.
- **Augmented product:** the additional value that differentiates Botiaghata from a generic riverside stop — guided storytelling, QR-based interpretation points, community-hosted experiences, and a consistent destination brand.

Around this framework, the tourism product is built from riverside tranquility, boating and floating dining, eco-park recreation, local food and culture, and light eco-tourism activity — described in detail in Section 7.

4. Tourism Product Life Cycle Analysis

The Tourism Product Life Cycle (TPLC) is a widely used model describing how a destination evolves from initial discovery through to consolidation or, if poorly managed, stagnation and decline. Applying this model to Botiaghata helps clarify its current position and the strategic actions needed to move it forward responsibly.

Botiaghata is currently assessed as being at the Exploration stage. This assessment is based on three observable conditions: awareness of the site is limited to local residents and a small number of nearby travellers; there is no established tourism infrastructure such as hotels, structured activities, or guided tours; and the site remains largely in its natural, untouched state. These are the defining characteristics of the Exploration stage in the TPLC model, and they match Botiaghata's present situation directly.

Stage	Destination Situation	Development Characteristics	Recommended Strategic Action
1. Exploration (current stage)	Known mainly to local residents and a few travellers; visited informally.	No established infrastructure; site is largely untouched and authentic.	Protect natural character while introducing minimal, low-impact infrastructure (signage, paths, waste bins).
2. Involvement	Local community begins organizing basic services around visitor activity.	Picnic spots, clean pathways, parking, signage, and boat rides introduced; vendors begin offering tea, snacks, handicrafts.	Support local vendors and introduce light regulation and coordination through local administration.
3. Development	Structured tourism infrastructure appears; the destination begins active marketing.	Public toilets, eco-friendly accommodation, security systems, organized entertainment; tour packages and seasonal festivals introduced.	Formalize a tourism board or coordinating body; begin structured promotion and quality standards.
4. Consolidation	Botiaghata becomes a recognized riverside retreat with growing, steady visitor numbers.	Revenue supports maintenance and sustainability projects; local entrepreneurship matures.	Reinvest revenue into infrastructure upkeep and diversify the product to sustain repeat visitation.
5. Stagnation (risk to avoid)	Overcrowding or loss of the site's original charm without corrective action.	Environmental strain, declining visitor satisfaction, erosion of authenticity.	Maintain controlled visitor growth, enforce environmental limits, and keep eco-tourism principles central to all planning.

Table 1. Tourism Product Life Cycle — stages and strategic actions

The strategic priority for Botiaghata at present is a controlled, deliberate transition from Exploration into Involvement — introducing light infrastructure and formal community participation without triggering premature, unmanaged development that would undermine the destination's core appeal.

5. SWOT Analysis

A SWOT analysis clarifies Botiaghata's internal strengths and weaknesses alongside external opportunities and threats, providing the basis for the strategic recommendations that follow.

Strengths	Weaknesses
- Natural beauty: river, lush landscape, open air. - Strategic location: easily accessible from Khulna city. - Low development cost: nature is already the main attraction. - Peaceful environment: suited to relaxation and photography.	- Lack of facilities: no restrooms, shelters, food courts, or seating. - Limited awareness: not featured on travel platforms or packages. - Seasonal attraction: rainy season may cause flooding or muddy paths. - Poor waste management: litter reduces the site's appeal.
Opportunities	Threats
- Eco-tourism and river cruises: floating cafés, paddle boats. - Local economic boost: handicrafts, homestays, food stalls. - Public-private partnership investment potential. - Events and festivals: riverside music nights, food fests, art shows.	- Unplanned development leading to environmental degradation. - Over-tourism disturbing local life or polluting the river. - Political instability affecting investment. - Climate impact: rising water levels or unpredictable weather.

5.1 TOWS Strategic Response

The strategies below are derived directly from the SWOT findings above, matching internal capabilities to external conditions.

Strategy Type	Strategic Response
SO — Strengths–Opportunities	Use the river and natural landscape as the centrepiece of an eco-tourism offering (floating cafés, paddle boats) that leverages proximity to Khulna to attract public-private investment.
ST — Strengths–Threats	Direct development toward low-impact, nature-based infrastructure to protect the river and landscape from the effects of over-tourism and unplanned building.
WO — Weaknesses–Opportunities	Channel early public-private and CSR investment into essential facilities (toilets, waste systems, shelters) alongside the launch of income-generating attractions such as boat tours and food stalls.
WT — Weaknesses–Threats	Introduce basic waste management and flood-aware site planning early, before visitor numbers grow, to prevent environmental degradation from compounding existing facility gaps.

Table 2. TOWS strategy matrix

6. Market Segmentation and Target Markets

Botiaghata's early-stage development calls for a segmentation approach centred on accessible, regional demand, with more distant markets treated as a future expansion opportunity rather than an initial target.

Segment	Needs / Motivations	Relevant Tourism Product	Marketing Channel	Priority
Local day visitors (families & social groups)	Affordable outdoor leisure, picnicking, relaxation close to home	Riverside walk, picnic areas, boat rides	Word of mouth, local Facebook groups, on-site signage	Primary
Students & university groups	Low-cost group outings, photography, informal recreation	Group boat tours, eco-park, photo points	University travel clubs, campus outreach, social media	Primary
Domestic weekend travellers (Khulna & Dhaka)	Short escape from city life, scenic relaxation	Full-day itinerary, floating café, sunset boat ride	Online travel content, influencer visits, travel forums	Secondary
Couples	Quiet, scenic settings for leisure or romantic outings	Sunset boating, riverside photography, dining	Instagram, targeted social content	Secondary
Nature & photography enthusiasts	Authentic landscapes, birdwatching, unspoilt scenery	Eco-park trails, guided nature walks	Photography communities, YouTube, blogs	Secondary
International visitors & Bangladeshi expatriates	Authentic rural experience, cultural immersion	Homestays, guided cultural tours (future phase)	Tourism board partnerships, diaspora networks	Future / Expansion

Table 3. Target market segmentation

Local and regional day visitors and student groups are treated as the primary market because they require the least infrastructure to serve and can generate early visibility and revenue. Weekend travellers, couples, and nature enthusiasts form a secondary market that becomes more accessible once Phase 2 infrastructure (Section 11) is in place. International and expatriate visitors are positioned as a future-phase market, contingent on the destination reaching the Development stage of the product life cycle.

7. Core Tourism Experience and Product Portfolio

The core experience defines what a visitor to Botiaghata actually feels, does, and remembers. For Botiaghata, this experience is built around serenity, nature, and riverside charm, expressed through seven complementary themes.

1. Riverside Tranquility

The slow-moving river, open air, and distant sounds of boats create a calm atmosphere suited to walking, quiet reflection, or simply watching the sky change over the water.

2. Scenic Beauty and Photography

Wide river views and dramatic skies make Botiaghata attractive for photography, particularly around sunrise and sunset, supporting organic social-media promotion by visitors themselves.

3. Family and Group Leisure

The open riverbank and proposed picnic areas suit family outings, school field trips, couple outings, and informal group gatherings.

4. Floating Dining Concepts

A proposed floating café or restaurant on the river — consistent with rising trends in riverside tourism elsewhere in Bangladesh — is positioned as a signature future attraction, offering local food in a distinctive setting once Phase 2 infrastructure is in place.

5. Cultural and Local Lifestyle Exposure

Visitor interaction with local fishermen, residents, and vendors offers exposure to traditional Khulna food, crafts, and everyday riverine life, adding cultural depth to the natural experience.

6. Eco-Tourism Possibilities

Nature-based activities such as birdwatching, tree-identification walks, and river clean-up events can involve visitors directly in sustainable practices, supported by seasonal eco-fairs or boating festivals.

7. Low-Cost, High-Value Access

Because the experience relies on natural rather than built assets, it can remain affordable for domestic and student travellers, keeping the destination inclusive rather than exclusive.

Taken together, these themes form a multi-layered leisure experience combining nature, calm, light adventure, food, and culture with a distinctly local character — the foundation for a signature riverside tourism product that can, over time, appeal to both domestic and international travellers.

8. Tourist Itinerary

The itinerary below illustrates a representative one-day visit, sequencing arrival, activities, and meals to make full use of the proposed tourism product and supporting infrastructure.

Time	Activity	Visitor Experience	Required Facility / Service
8:00 – 10:00 AM	Arrival & orientation	Arrival from Khulna city; welcome drink and snacks; safety and schedule briefing	Transport access, welcome/information centre
10:00 AM – 12:00 PM	Riverside walk & photography	Guided walking trail, photography points, watchtower view; stop at floating café for refreshments	Marked walking trail, signage, floating café
12:00 – 2:00 PM	Boating & eco-park	Boat or paddleboat ride; guided tree-walk or picnic at eco-park; lunch at a river-view open-air restaurant	Licensed boats, life jackets, eco-park facilities, dining area
2:00 – 4:00 PM	Culture & leisure	Cultural performance or handicraft fair; souvenir shopping; rest and refreshments	Performance space, vendor stalls, seating/shade
4:00 – 6:00 PM	Sunset & departure	Sunset boat ride or riverside photoshoot; return journey to Khulna	Boat services, transport pick-up point

Table 4. Sample one-day tourist itinerary

9. Infrastructure and Visitor Facility Plan

Infrastructure requirements are grouped into nine functional categories. Each category supports a specific part of the visitor experience and can be introduced progressively in line with the phased development plan in Section 11.

Accessibility & Transport

A paved access road from Khulna to Botiaghata, directional signage, and sheltered bus or auto-rickshaw stops are the foundation for all other tourism activity, since visitors cannot be served safely or comfortably without reliable access.

Visitor Information

A welcome centre offering maps, orientation, and restrooms, supported by digital QR codes for self-guided exploration, gives visitors a clear starting point and reduces reliance on staffed guiding for every visit.

Sanitation

Public toilets, changing facilities, and a reliable drinking-water supply address the single most frequently cited gap in the current site (see Section 5, Weaknesses) and are treated as a Phase 1 priority.

Safety & Security

Local tourism security personnel, signage on hazard areas, and organized crowd management protect visitors, particularly around the riverbank and boating areas.

Boating & Floating Facilities

Licensed and regularly inspected boats, life jackets, trained boat operators, and ticket booths are essential to any activity conducted on the water, including the proposed floating café concept.

Accommodation (Phase 2)

Eco-lodges and trained homestays with river views extend Botiaghata's appeal from a day-trip to a weekend destination, and are proposed as a Phase 2/3 addition once day-visitor infrastructure is established.

Recreation

Benches, shaded seating, lighting, picnic zones, a children's play area, and a small open-air performance space support the family- and group-leisure dimension of the core experience described in Section 7.

Digital Infrastructure

Wi-Fi access at key points and a mobile app or website for booking, navigation, and event information make the destination accessible to younger, tech-oriented visitors and support the digital marketing plan in Section 13.

Waste & Environmental Management

Waste bins, a collection and disposal system, and basic environmental monitoring protect the natural asset on which the entire tourism product depends, directly addressing the poor waste management weakness identified in Section 5.

Introducing this infrastructure in stages — rather than all at once — allows Botiaghata to meet rising visitor demand while keeping development proportionate to the destination's capacity and its natural character.

10. Proposed Destination Spatial Layout

A simplified spatial layout has been prepared to show how key tourist facilities would be arranged along the riverside area, supporting easy access, safe visitor movement, and a clear separation between natural and built zones.

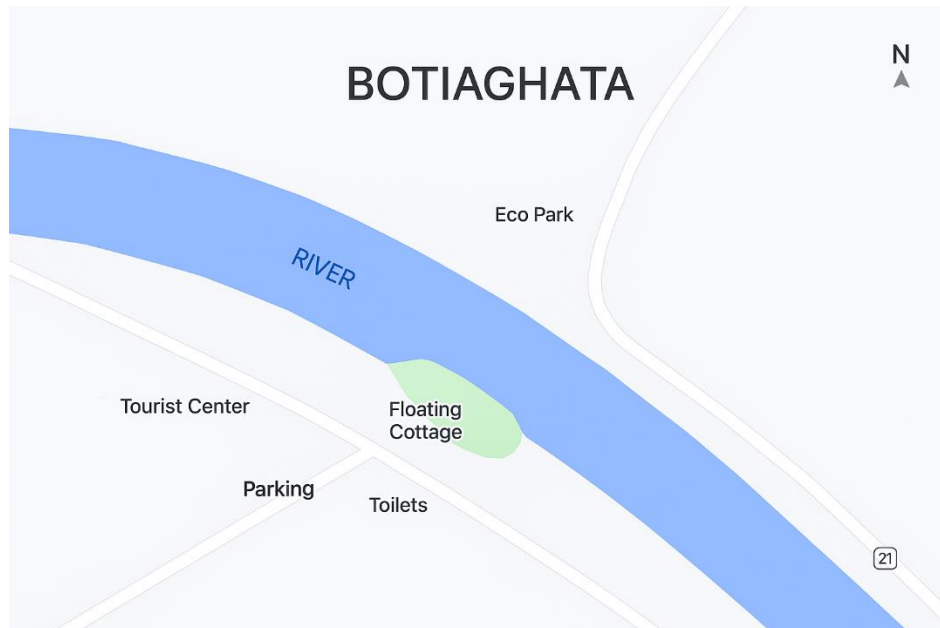


Figure 3. Proposed spatial layout of Botiaghata tourism development

10.1 Key Elements of the Layout

- **River as the central feature:** the river runs diagonally through the site and forms the destination's main attraction, used for boating, floating cottages, and riverside relaxation.
- **Floating Cottage zone:** positioned directly on the riverbank, this zone is planned for floating café and leisure structures, suited to dining, photography, and quiet enjoyment of the water.
- **Eco Park:** located on the upper side of the site beside the riverbank and access road, planned for tree trails, picnic tables, open green space, and children's activity areas.
- **Tourist Center:** positioned on the lower side of the site as the main reception and information hub, where visitors can obtain maps, guidance, and tickets.
- **Parking:** sited adjacent to the Tourist Center to keep private vehicles, buses, and auto-rickshaws organized and off the main roadway.
- **Toilets:** positioned centrally near the parking and tourist-center cluster for convenient access from all zones.
- **Road connectivity:** the site connects to the surrounding road network, including the adjacent regional route, with all zones linked by roads and walkways and guided by clear signage.

10.2 Planning Value of the Layout

- Gives visual structure to the overall development plan and sequencing described in Section 11.
- Supports smooth visitor movement and safety by separating vehicle, pedestrian, and water-based activity.

- Maintains a balance between natural preservation and tourist access by concentrating built facilities on the landward side of the site.
- Leaves room for future expansion — homestays, additional vendor space, and event zones — without disrupting the core layout.

11. Phased Destination Development Plan

The transformation of Botiaghata into a functioning tourist destination is proposed as a phased, sustainable process that aligns infrastructure investment, environmental protection, and community involvement over a five-year horizon and beyond.

Phase	Timeframe	Major Actions	Expected Outputs	Key Stakeholders
Phase 1 — Basic Setup	Year 1	Riverside clean-up and landscaping; road and signage improvement from Khulna city; installation of toilets, benches, picnic spots, and bins; appointment of local security; community awareness meetings	Safe, welcoming environment for domestic tourists; initial interest from group tours, student trips, and families; early growth of tea stalls and small local vendors	Local government / Union Parishad, local community, tourism security
Phase 2 — Structured Tourism Infrastructure	Year 2–3	5–10 floating restaurants/café; wooden eco-friendly tourist centre; licensed paddle and motorboats; eco-park with trails and watchtower; solar lighting, tube wells, limited Wi-Fi; website and mobile app with booking system	Botiaghata becomes a recognized weekend getaway in southern Bangladesh; engagement of entrepreneurs, NGOs, and tour operators; increased visitors from outside Khulna	Private investors, tour operators, NGOs, tourism board
Phase 3 — Diversification & Sustainability	Year 4–5	Homestay training and certification (10–15 homes); annual cultural events calendar; skill-training centres for guides, boat drivers, and artisans; green waste-management centre; accessibility pathways for differently-abled visitors	Repeat visitors and stronger online presence; deeper links between locals and the tourism economy; interest from NGOs and development agencies	Community leaders, youth groups, NGOs, training providers
Long-Term Vision	Beyond Year 5	Position Botiaghata as “The Riverside Heart of Khulna,” targeting both domestic tourists and Bangladeshi expatriates seeking quiet family retreats	Recognized model for eco-tourism and community-based rural tourism in southern Bangladesh	All stakeholders (see Section 14)

Table 5. Phased destination development roadmap

The success of this roadmap depends on three consistent factors across all phases: community participation and benefit-sharing, environmentally conscious development that avoids overreach, and affordable pricing that preserves the destination's inclusive character even as facilities improve.

12. Sustainability and Community Engagement

Sustainability is treated as a condition for Botiaghata's development rather than a later addition, since the destination's entire value proposition depends on the natural riverside environment remaining intact. Four dimensions are addressed below.

Environmental Sustainability

- Structured waste collection and disposal to prevent the littering already identified as a weakness in Section 5.
- River protection measures, including limits on boat numbers and fuel-based traffic near ecologically sensitive banks.
- Green infrastructure — tree planting, permeable walkways, and shaded natural areas — in preference to heavy construction.
- Flood- and monsoon-aware site planning to reduce the impact of the seasonal weather risk noted in Section 15.

Economic Sustainability

- Priority local employment in food service, boating, guiding, and site maintenance roles.
- Support for local entrepreneurship through training and small-business facilitation rather than external commercial operators alone.
- Reinvestment of ticket and food revenue into ongoing site maintenance, consistent with the Consolidation-stage goal in Section 4.

Community Sustainability

- Structured community consultation before major infrastructure phases, beginning with the awareness meetings proposed in Phase 1.
- Skill-training programmes for guides, boat operators, and artisans, as set out in Phase 3.
- Fair, transparent participation of local vendors and homestay hosts in the tourism economy.

Visitor Responsibility

- Visitor education on waste disposal, respectful behaviour, and river safety at key entry points.
- Controlled visitor volumes during peak periods to avoid the overcrowding and stagnation risk identified in Section 4.
- Encouragement of low-impact activities (walking, birdwatching, photography) alongside boating and dining.

These measures directly address the environmental and social threats identified in the SWOT analysis (Section 5) — unplanned development, over-tourism, and climate-related risk — while keeping the development plan practical and achievable at community scale.

13. Destination Marketing Strategy

13.1 Destination Positioning

Botiaghata is positioned as an affordable, peaceful riverside escape within easy reach of Khulna — a destination defined by natural calm and local authenticity rather than large-scale commercial attractions. This positioning is intentionally distinct from Bangladesh's more developed hill and urban destinations, targeting travellers who specifically seek an unhurried, nature-based alternative.

13.2 7Ps Marketing Mix

7P	Strategic Objective	Proposed Actions	Visitor / Business Benefit
Product	Deliver a distinctive riverside leisure experience	Boat rides and floating dining, park and picnic areas, nature-based activities, village-culture exposure, local food and crafts	A differentiated, memorable product built on authentic local assets
Price	Keep the destination affordable and inclusive	Day-entry passes, hourly boat rides, food coupons; discounted student/group bundles; family picnic packages; future guided packages for foreign visitors	Wide accessibility across income groups, supporting the Primary market in Section 6
Place	Reach visitors where they already are	Promotion in Khulna, Jashore, Satkhira, and Bagerhat; Dhaka weekend-trip market; direct booking via website/app; local tour operators; university travel clubs	Efficient reach into both local and regional traveller pools
Promotion	Build awareness through digital and offline channels	Website and app; Facebook, Instagram, and YouTube content (drone footage, sunset reels, testimonials); influencer collaboration; posters at transport hubs; tourism expos; school/college outreach	Cost-effective visibility suited to a developing destination's budget
People	Ensure a consistently welcoming visitor experience	Trained local youth guides; hospitality training for vendors, boatmen, and cottage staff; community hosts for storytelling	Stronger word-of-mouth promotion and repeat visitation
Process	Make the visitor journey smooth and transparent	Online booking for boats/events/packages; QR-based digital ticketing; signage and help desks; feedback and review collection; multilingual (Bengali/English) assistance	Reduced friction for first-time visitors and better service-quality feedback
Physical Evidence	Reinforce brand identity at every visitor touchpoint	Well-maintained walkways and signage; branded staff uniforms; consistent receipts, menus, and brochures; souvenir shop	Stronger brand recall and a more professional destination image

Table 6. 7Ps marketing mix for Botiaghata

13.3 Destination Branding

The recommended destination slogan is “Botiaghata – Where the River Whispers Peace,” chosen for its direct emotional connection to the site's central asset — the river — and its alignment with the calm, restorative positioning described above. The slogan implies a brand promise of tranquility and gentle discovery, matched

to a destination personality that is quiet, natural, and unhurried, and to a target audience seeking relief from urban pace rather than high-energy entertainment.

The following alternative slogans were also considered and may be retained as secondary messaging for specific campaigns or audiences:

- “Flow with Nature, Rest in Botiaghata”
- “Khulna's Hidden River Gem”
- “Botiaghata: Escape to the Rhythm of the River”

13.4 Digital Marketing Plan

Platform	Content	Audience	Objective	Example
Facebook	Event updates, local community stories, group-travel offers	Local & regional day visitors, families	Awareness and direct community reach	Local Facebook travel and community groups
Instagram	Photography, short reels, visitor-generated content	Couples, students, photography enthusiasts	Visual brand building and engagement	Sunset boat-ride reels, #BotiaghataEscape posts
YouTube	Drone footage, destination walkthroughs, testimonials	Weekend travellers, prospective first-time visitors	In-depth destination storytelling	“A Day at Botiaghata” style video
Website / App	Booking, maps, event calendar, virtual tour	All segments, especially direct bookers	Conversion and trip planning	Online boat-ride and package booking
QR-based on-site content	Local history, ecology, and storytelling at physical points	On-site visitors	Deepen on-site engagement	QR-linked story points (Section 13.5)

Table 7. Proposed digital marketing plan

13.5 Promotional Campaigns

The campaign concepts below were part of the original project brief and are retained and developed here with clearer execution detail. All results and engagement figures referenced are illustrative targets, not measured outcomes.

Campaign	Objective	Target Audience	Execution / Platform	KPI (Proposed)
Sunset Stories	Generate organic visual promotion	Photography enthusiasts, couples, students	Instagram photo contest using #BotiaghataEscape; winners receive free picnic passes or boat rides	Number of contest entries and hashtag uses
Local Influencer Day	Build credible, locally-relevant awareness	Regional social-media audiences	Invite Khulna-based content creators to document the journey, food, and culture	Reach and engagement on partner content

Campaign	Objective	Target Audience	Execution / Platform	KPI (Proposed)
Eco-Volunteer Programme	Combine promotion with environmental upkeep	University students, youth groups	Tree-planting and clean-up days in exchange for free tickets	Number of volunteer participants per event
Khulna City Float Parade	Create a seasonal, media-worthy event	General public, regional media	Parade of decorated boats during Pohela Boishakh or Eid, with media coverage	Media coverage secured; attendance at the event
QR-Linked Story Points	Deepen on-site engagement and education	All on-site visitors	Boards with QR codes linking to short videos or text on Botiaghata's history, trees, and local figures	Number of QR scans recorded

Table 8. Promotional campaign framework

14. Stakeholder Management

Delivering the development plan in Section 11 depends on coordinated participation from a defined set of stakeholders, each with a distinct role and interest in the project's success.

Stakeholder	Role	Contribution	Engagement Strategy
Local Government / Union Parishad	Regulatory authority and local coordination	Permits, basic infrastructure support, security coordination	Regular briefings; formal partnership agreement
Khulna / Bangladesh Tourism Board	Sector promotion and standards	Marketing support, potential grant funding	Proposal submission; inclusion in regional promotion
Community Leaders & Youth Groups	Local representation and mobilization	Community buy-in, labour, local knowledge	Awareness meetings (Phase 1); ongoing consultation
Private Investors & Restaurant Operators	Capital and commercial operation	Investment in floating cafés, boats, and facilities	Investment proposals; revenue-sharing discussions
Local NGOs & Environmental Groups	Sustainability oversight and training	Environmental monitoring, skill-training delivery	Partnership on Phase 3 training and waste programmes
Media & Influencers	Awareness generation	Content creation, organic and paid reach	Local Influencer Day campaign (Section 13.5)
Local Guides & Boat Operators	Front-line service delivery	Direct visitor interaction and safety	Hospitality and safety training programmes

Table 9. Stakeholder engagement matrix

15. Risk and Challenge Management

The risks below are drawn from the SWOT threats identified in Section 5 and the development considerations discussed throughout this report. Likelihood and impact ratings are planning judgements intended to guide prioritization, not measured probabilities.

Risk	Likelihood	Impact	Mitigation
Seasonal flooding / monsoon weather	High	Medium	Flood-aware site planning; raised or floating structures; seasonal operating adjustments
Environmental degradation from unplanned development	Medium	High	Phased development limits (Section 11); green infrastructure preference (Section 12)
Poor waste management	High	Medium	Dedicated waste bins and collection system introduced in Phase 1 (Section 9, 11)
Overcrowding / over-tourism	Medium	High	Controlled visitor volumes; capacity limits during peak periods (Section 12)
Visitor safety on the water	Medium	High	Licensed boats, life jackets, trained operators, security presence (Section 9)
Inconsistent service quality	Medium	Medium	Structured hospitality training for guides, vendors, and boat operators (Section 13.2)
Insufficient or delayed investment	Medium	High	Diversified funding mix: government, PPP, CSR, NGO, and revenue reinvestment (Section 16)
Political or administrative instability	Low	Medium	Multi-stakeholder governance rather than reliance on a single authority (Section 14)
Seasonal demand fluctuation	High	Low	Event-based programming (festivals, campaigns) to sustain off-peak visitation (Section 13.5)

Table 10. Risk and mitigation matrix

16. Budget and Financial Plan

The table below presents the indicative development budget for Botiaghata, organized by category and mapped to the development phase in which each cost is expected to arise. All figures are drawn from the original project estimate and are presented as planning figures rather than verified contractor quotations.

Indicative / Estimated Development Budget — figures are planning estimates, not confirmed costs.

Category	Components	Estimated Cost (BDT)	Phase
1. Riverside Clean-up & Beautification	Tree planting, grass trimming, signage boards, seating benches	Tk. 5,00,000	Phase 1
2. Tourist Information Centre (Small)	Wooden structure, desk, solar light, tourist maps, Wi-Fi setup	Tk. 7,00,000	Phase 2
3. Roadside & Parking Improvements	Levelling, signage, parking lines, shaded area	Tk. 4,00,000	Phase 1
4. Public Toilets & Drinking Water Setup	Eco-toilets, water tanks, filtration units	Tk. 3,50,000	Phase 1
5. Floating Cafés / Boats (5 Units)	Bamboo/steel structure on barrels, roofing, seating	Tk. 15,00,000	Phase 2
6. Eco-Park Zone & Walking Trail	Trails, shade areas, open green lawn, kids' zone, signboards	Tk. 6,00,000	Phase 2
7. Boat Licensing & Life Jackets	Safe boats (5–6), life jackets, security staff	Tk. 4,50,000	Phase 2
8. Digital Booking System + Website/App	Web development, QR ticketing, maintenance, online map	Tk. 3,00,000	Phase 2
9. Homestay / Training (Initial 10 Homes)	Bedsheets, fans, hygiene kits, hospitality training	Tk. 6,50,000	Phase 3
10. Cultural Setup (Stage, PA System, Lights)	Basic open-air stage, mic setup, seating for small events	Tk. 2,00,000	Phase 3
11. Branding & Marketing Campaign	Social media, posters, banners, influencer visits, YouTube ads	Tk. 10,00,000	Phase 1–2
12. Security & Waste Management	Security guards, waste bins, disposal service	Tk. 3,00,000	Phase 1
13. Administrative & Miscellaneous Buffer	Unexpected costs, approvals, local donations	Tk. 3,00,000	All phases

Table 11. Indicative development budget

Total Estimated Budget: Tk. 87,50,000 BDT (approximately USD 80,000)

16.1 Funding Suggestions

- Local Government (Khulna Zila Parishad / Union Parishad)
- Public-Private Partnership (PPP)

- CSR Funding from Banks and Corporates
- NGOs focusing on rural development
- Tourism Board Grants (Bangladesh Parjatan Corporation)
- Ticket and food revenue reinvestment model

17. Monitoring and Evaluation Framework (KPIs)

The indicators below are proposed monitoring categories for tracking the development plan's progress. They are planning targets to guide future data collection, not measured results, and would need to be baselined once implementation begins.

Category	Proposed Indicators (Illustrative)
Visitor Experience	Visitor satisfaction ratings; repeat-visitation rate
Marketing	Social-media engagement and follower growth; #BotiaghataEscape hashtag usage; QR-point scan counts
Community Development	Number of local businesses engaged; local employment generated; training-programme participation
Environmental Sustainability	Waste-management performance; river water-quality observations; tree-planting participation
Operational Performance	Boat and facility utilization rates; service-quality feedback scores
Local Economic Impact	Growth in local vendor revenue; homestay occupancy (from Phase 3)

Table 12. Proposed monitoring and evaluation indicators (KPIs)

These are proposed KPIs for future monitoring, not measured results from this project.

18. Conclusion

Botiaghata, a naturally rich riverside locality in Khulna, holds the essential elements required to become a distinctive destination for sustainable tourism in Bangladesh: a serene environment, scenic river views, cultural depth, and an engaged local community. These qualities make it a strong candidate for a destination-based tourism product that is both experience-driven and socially beneficial.

The Tourism Product Life Cycle analysis in Section 4 shows that Botiaghata remains in its early Exploration stage, with substantial room for structured growth. Development must proceed in a phased manner that balances new infrastructure with environmental preservation, as set out in the roadmap in Section 11. The SWOT analysis in Section 5 highlighted genuine strengths — natural beauty and accessibility — alongside clear gaps in sanitation and visitor facilities that this plan is designed to close.

The core visitor experience, detailed in Section 7, centres on relaxation, connection to nature, and authentic local engagement: boat rides, floating dining, riverside photography, and traditional food, delivered in an affordable and accessible setting. The itinerary and infrastructure plan in Sections 8 and 9 ensure that visitors can experience a full, comfortable, and secure day at the destination, while the digital infrastructure and booking systems described in Section 13 extend that accessibility to younger, technology-oriented travellers.

The phased development plan reflects a deliberately adaptive approach — basic clean-up and signage in Phase 1, boat services and floating restaurants in Phase 2, and homestays, training, and cultural programming in Phase 3. The marketing strategy built around the 7Ps framework and the slogan “Where the River Whispers Peace” gives this development a consistent, emotionally resonant identity, supported by promotional activity — influencer visits, photo contests, and eco-volunteering — designed to encourage genuine visitor interaction rather than passive advertising.

The indicative budget of Tk. 87,50,000 BDT presented in Section 16 represents a realistic and achievable investment when drawn from a mix of government support, CSR contributions, public-private partnership, and reinvested tourism revenue. Beyond its function as a tourism venture, this plan represents an investment in rural revitalization, youth employment, environmental stewardship, and local pride.

In conclusion, Botiaghata has the potential to become not only a recognized tourist destination but also a working model for sustainable, community-based tourism in Bangladesh — one where development is measured as much by community benefit and environmental care as by visitor numbers. With disciplined phased planning, genuine community inclusion, and consistent marketing, Botiaghata can demonstrate a replicable approach to developing Bangladesh's smaller riverine destinations.